

End of Unit Quiz Pack

Instructions: Answer the 50 quick-fire recall questions below. If you get stuck, the scrambled answers are provided in the Answer Bank on the final page.

1. What technology did Roman engineers use to bring fresh water over miles into British towns?

2. Where sat Roman soldiers side-by-side over water-flushed latrine channels?

3. What did Roman soldiers use to wipe themselves in communal latrines?

4. What did Roman bathers experience inside a bathhouse like Bearsden?

5. What is a famous Roman bath complex located in Somerset, England?

6. What is a 'hypocaust' in Roman architecture?

7. What were Roman public toilets called?

8. What Roman philosopher complained about the noise in a public bathhouse?

9. How did early Iron Age Britons dispose of waste safely?

10. Why was Iron Age waste disposal effective?

11. Why did medieval villages like Wharram Percy avoid major public health crises despite using simple cesspits?

12. On the twelfth-century plans of Canterbury Priory, what did the red lines represent?

13. How did poorer townspeople get their fresh water if they did not own a private well?

14. What material did archaeologists discover in medieval cesspits that shows how villagers wiped themselves?

15. Why did medieval 'gongfermers' perform their job exclusively under the cover of darkness?

16. What was the term for a medieval toilet, meaning 'wardrobe'?

17. Where did garderobes in castles usually empty their waste?

18. What organization in medieval times had the best access to clean piped water?

19. Who was employed to clean out medieval cesspits?

20. What was the main source of water for early medieval towns before pipes were common?

21. Why did London's sanitation problems get worse during the Early Modern period?

22. Which famous seventeenth-century Londoner wrote about his cellar being flooded by his neighbor's toilet waste?

23. Who invented the first water closet (flushing toilet) in Britain in 1596?

25. What was a 'water seller's' job in an Early Modern town?

27. In what year was the New River completed?

29. Why did Samuel Pepys' cellar flood with waste?

31. By how much did Britain's population grow during the century of industrialisation (1750–1850)?

33. What was the terrifying waterborne disease that first struck Britain in 1831, killing 31,000 people?

35. Why did cesspits under shared yard privies frequently overflow in industrial cities?

24. Why was the 1596 flushing toilet not used by ordinary citizens?

26. Who constructed the New River to bring fresh water to London?

28. What were Early Modern 'conduits'?

30. What was a major consequence of overcrowded towns in the Early Modern period?

32. How did working-class families living in terraced yards usually obtain their water?

34. What scientific theory did Victorian doctors believe in before they understood that cholera was spread by dirty water?

36. What was a 'back-to-back' house?

37. Who published the 1842 Report on the Sanitary Condition of the Labouring Population?

39. What was the main problem with the 1848 Public Health Act?

41. How did John Snow stop the Soho cholera outbreak of 1854?

43. Which French scientist proved 'Germ Theory' in 1860, showing that microscopic organisms cause disease?

45. How many miles of brick sewers did Joseph Bazalgette construct beneath London?

47. What modern facility replaced the old, unhygienic shared privies by the late 19th century?

38. What act was passed in 1848 as a result of Chadwick's report?

40. What was the primary symptom of Cholera?

42. What event in the summer of 1858 finally forced politicians to fund London's sewer network?

44. What did the landmark 1875 Public Health Act force local councils to do?

46. What was Joseph Bazalgette's profession?

48. What happened to the River Thames during the Great Stink?

49. Why did Parliament suddenly care about the Great Stink?

50. How did John Snow map the 1854 Cholera outbreak?

Quiz Pack Answer Bank

1,300 miles • 1613 • A wet sponge attached to the end of a shared wooden stick • An underfloor heating system used in bathhouses • Aquae Sulis (Bath) • By digging simple cesspits in spread-out roundhouse settlements • Cesspits overflowed and contaminated drinking water supplies • Cheap, crowded industrial housing with shared privies and no back gardens • Cholera • Civil Engineer • Directly into the moat or a cesspit at the base of the wall • Edwin Chadwick • Ensure all houses had piped clean water and proper sewer connections • Flushing toilets connected to Bazalgette's sewer system • From a shared pump in the street or yard that only ran for a few hours • Garderobe • Gongfarmers (or Gong Farmers) • He mapped the deaths and noticed they clustered around the Broad Street pump • He persuaded the local parish to remove the Broad Street pump handle • His neighbor's cesspit overflowed directly into it • Houses lacked running piped water and connections to street sewers • Housesteads Fort on Hadrian's Wall • It skyrocketed from 6 million to 21 million • It was not compulsory, so many towns ignored it to save money • Landlords refused to pay for them to be emptied, and they were not connected to sewers • Latrines • Louis Pasteur • Low population density meant waste didn't contaminate water supplies • Miasma Theory (the belief that disease is spread by bad smells) • Monasteries and Priors • Pipes carrying dirty waste water away to flush the toilets • Public water fountains where citizens could collect fresh water • Rivers, streams, and local wells • Samuel Pepys • Seneca the Younger • Severe diarrhea, dehydration, and blue skin • Sir Hugh Myddelton • Sir John Harington • Stone channels called conduits that utilized the natural pull of gravity • The Great Stink of the River Thames • The low population density meant waste did not build up enough to contaminate water supplies • The population grew rapidly, putting too much pressure on crowded town systems • The Public Health Act 1848 • The river level dropped during a heatwave, exposing rotting sewage • The smell was so terrible it reached the Houses of Parliament • They bought it from water sellers who hauled river water in barrels • To avoid disrupting the busy town streets with terrible smells and waste carts • Transporting river water in large barrels on horseback to sell to homes • Washing in sequence through cold, warm, and hot rooms • Wild moss